

Operational Policy

Policy title:	Email Security Policy		
Policy number:	ODHSOHA 090-015		
Original date:	02/07/2022	Last update:	02/01/2026
Approved:	Seth Lyon COO ODHS Kris Kautz Deputy Director OHA		

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure Oregon Department of Human Services (ODHS) and the Oregon Health Authority (OHA) staff use email appropriately and safely to prevent the introduction of computer viruses and security threats, and protect organizational data from unauthorized data access, data loss, and loss of productivity.

Description

This policy outlines ways to ensure secure, safe, and effective use of email.

Applicability

This policy applies to all ODHS and OHA staff including full-time, part-time, contingent, temporary, and limited duration employees, volunteers, trainees, and interns.

As keepers of the public trust, all ODHS and OHA staff play a vital role in upholding state and agency policies, administrative rules, and state and federal laws. ODHS and OHA are committed to exceptional public and customer service. The agencies are dedicated to maintaining standards of exceptional service and trust staff to do the same. Failure to follow policies, rules and laws may result in beginning a personnel process to consider formal action as appropriate, including progressive discipline up to and including dismissal from state service.

If this policy is intended to apply to contractors or grantees the necessary language must be incorporated into the contract.

Policy

1. ODHS and OHA staff shall protect email by ensuring emails and attachments containing confidential and sensitive information are sent to authorized recipients. Authorized recipients are individuals or entities who need access to the information to carry out a specific, legitimate purpose and only to the extent necessary to fulfill that purpose
2. Federal Tax Information (FTI) shall not be sent by email or fax.
3. Criminal Justice Information (CJI) shall only be transmitted to Criminal Justice Information Service (CJIS)-authorized staff using secure methods such as secure file transfer or encrypted email.

4. Staff using state provided email systems for messages containing sensitive and confidential information shall use approved encryption standards to send the email securely.
 - a. Staff shall manually secure outgoing email using #secure# in the subject line.
 - b. Staff shall not use the Encrypt button to secure outgoing email.¹
 - c. Staff shall add a sensitivity label when appropriate by using the Sensitivity button under the Message in Outlook² in compliance with DAS 107-004-050 Information Asset Classification Policy.
 - d. Sensitive or confidential information in the subject line is strictly prohibited.
5. Use of email shall comply with DAS 107-004-110 Acceptable Use of State Information Assets.
6. Staff shall not forward emails containing sensitive or confidential information from their state email accounts to their personal or non-state related email accounts.
7. Auto-forwarding ODHS and OHA email to any email address outside of the .gov domain is prohibited and can only be configured by an administrator.
8. Suspicious emails or emails suspected to be phishing attempts shall be reported immediately using the Phish Alert Report button.
9. If Criminal Justice Information (CJI), Federal Tax Information (FTI), Payment Card Industry (PCI), Protected Health Information (PHI), or Social Security Administration (SSA) data is accidentally disclosed by email or fax, staff are required to report the incident immediately upon identification in accordance with ODHSOHA 090-005-01 Information Security Incident Reporting Process.

References

[45 CFR 160 General Administrative Requirements](#)
[45 CFR 164 Security and Privacy](#)
[Oregon Revised Statutes \(ORS\) 164.377 Computer Crime](#)
[OAR 407-014-0000 Privacy and Confidentiality](#)
[OAR 943-014-0000 Privacy and Confidentiality](#)
[Criminal Justice Information Services \(CJIS\) Security Policy](#)
[Criminal Justice Information Services Law Enforcement Data Systems](#)
[Internal Revenue Service Publication 1075, Tax Information Security Guidelines for Federal, State and Local Agencies](#)
[National Institute of Standards and Technology \(NIST\) Special Publications \(SP\) 800-53 Rev. 5](#)
[Acceptable Risk controls for Affordable Care Act for Medicaid Partner Exchanges](#)
[Enterprise Information Services M365 Secure Collaboration, Sensitivity Labels-User Guide](#)
[Statewide Information Security Program Plan](#)
[Statewide Information Technology \(IT\) Control Standards](#)
[Standards Alignment with CIS Critical Security Controls](#)
[Center for Internet Security Critical Security Controls v8.1](#)
[ODHSOHA 090-005-01 Information Security Incident Reporting Process](#)
[ODHSOHA 090-005-02 Information Security Incident Reporting Process Map](#)
[Secure Email Delivery-OWL](#)

¹ [Secure Email Delivery-OWL](#)

² Enterprise Information Services M365 Secure Collaboration, Sensitivity Labels-User Guide

Related policies

[Department of Administrative Services \(DAS\) 107-001-020 Public Records Management](#)

[DAS 107-004-050 Information Asset Classification](#)

[DAS 107-004-110 Acceptable Use of State Information Assets](#)

[ODHSOHA 010-018 Record Retention and Management Policy](#)

[ODHSOHA 090-005 Information Security Incident Management Policy](#)

[ODHSOHA 090-009 Administrative, Technical and Physical Safeguards of Information Policy](#)

[ODHSOHA 100-014 Report and Response to Privacy Incidents](#)

This policy shall be reviewed at least once every year to ensure relevance.

Contact

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Policy history

Version 1 ODHSOHA established 02/07/2022

Version 2 ODHSOHA revised 07/01/2024

Version 3 ODHSOHA revised 02/01/2026

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